

Parent Coordinator Tracker

Complete Setup & User Guide

Set-up · Buttons & Features · Migration & Updates · Privacy

A Google Sheets tool that turns your ATS export into a live directory, tracks every family contact, and compiles your PCAR — automatically.

Made by a fellow Parent Coordinator — this is NOT an official DOE sheet. · jacob.keller@p94m.org

Get Your Copy

Start from one of the two templates below. Each opens a **"Make a copy"** prompt, so you get your own private sheet in your own Google Drive.

📄 New Coordinator — Make a Blank Copy

🔄 Upgrading — Make a Migrate Copy

Template	Who it's for
📄 Blank Copy	Brand-new coordinators starting fresh — paste your ATS export and go.
🔄 Migrate Copy	Coordinators upgrading from an older version — it auto-opens the Migration Wizard to bring last year's data and settings forward.

Coordinator note — update these two links each release

Both templates live in this Drive folder: drive.google.com/drive/folders/1goKFrxDJOSAPxp1HUXETX2dns5c6HXk2. Replace the two buttons above with the current (BLANK) and (MIGRATE) "make a copy" links whenever you ship a new version. Inside the sheet, the Welcome dialog and End-of-Year Rollover resolve these automatically from the folder — this printable guide is the one place you swap them by hand.

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Tap a button to jump to a section — the buttons and the table of contents below are clickable.

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What this tool is

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Getting this into Google Drive

> 📄 **How to open this as a Google Doc**
>
> Upload the .docx version to Google Drive (drag it into drive.google.com, or File → Open → Upload in Google Docs). Drive converts it into a Google Doc automatically. Step-by-step options are at the end of this guide.

What this tool is

The Parent Coordinator (PC) Tracker is a **Google Sheets add-on** built with Google Apps Script. You paste your student exports into one tab, and the tool automatically builds and maintains everything else: a clean class directory, a per-student contact log, PCAR reporting numbers, and — if you want it — a copy of the directory pushed into your phone through Google Contacts.

It's organized into three kinds of sheets:

- **The Engine** — RAW Data and the Backend tab's Type List, where you paste your system exports and customize your dropdowns.
- **The Workspaces** — Contact Log and Events, where you'll spend most of your day logging calls and workshops.
- **The Output** — automated sheets like Directory, Student List, Combined Contact Tracking, Parents Divided, PCAR, and Phone Contacts. You never type into these — they build themselves.

> **New here?**
> Do the one-time setup in Part 1, load your data, run Build, and you're running in a few minutes.

Part 1 — Setting Up Your Sheet

Quick Start (5 steps)

1. **Make your own copy** of the template (it opens a "Make a copy" prompt, or use File → Make a copy).
2. Open your copy, wait for 🚀 **App Menu** to appear, then click 🚀 **App Menu** → 🚨 **Initial Setup (Run Once)**.
3. Authorize the script when Google asks (one-time — see below).
4. Load your data into the **RAW Data** tab, or use 🔄 **Import Old Data** if upgrading.
5. Run 🏗️ **Build Sheets Only**, then press **F5** to refresh — the full menu unlocks.

Step 1 — Make a copy and open it

You always start from a shared template. Making a copy drops a fresh, private spreadsheet into your own Google Drive. The template is never touched by your work, and no one else can see your copy.

Step 2 — Run Initial Setup (once)

Wait until the 🚀 **App Menu** appears in the top toolbar — don't click anything else until it shows. Then click 🚀 **App Menu** → 🚨 **Initial Setup (Run Once)**. This does the behind-the-scenes wiring:

- Authorizes the script to run as you.
- Installs the automatic triggers — instant Contact Log updates, a nightly refresh/sync (around 10 PM), and a periodic update check.
- Records this copy as your original (a clone-detector so a later copy starts clean).
- Applies the default tab layout and opens this User Guide.

> **Until setup is done, the sheet is intentionally locked.**
> If you type before running Initial Setup, you'll see "🔒 Action Blocked — Initialization process needs to occur first." That's expected.

Step 3 — The authorization screen

Because this is a personal tool and not a paid Marketplace app, Google shows a warning like *"Google hasn't verified this app."* To continue, click **Advanced** → **Go to … (unsafe)** → **choose your account** → **Allow**.

"Unverified" means Google hasn't done a formal brand review — *not* that anything is wrong. You are granting permission to a script that runs entirely inside **your own** account.

What each authorization actually does

On the Allow screen, Google lists the permissions below. The tool asks only for what it needs — and everything runs inside your own account, so approving it does not give the developer any access.

Permission Google shows	What it's used for	Why it's needed
See, edit, create, and delete all your Google Sheets spreadsheets	Reading your RAW Data and writing the Student List, Directory, Contact Log, PCAR, and every other tab.	This is the whole engine — without it the tool can't build or update your sheets.
See, edit, download, and permanently delete your contacts	The optional "School Directory" phone sync that mirrors parent numbers into Google Contacts.	Only used if you turn on phone syncing. If you never enable it, nothing is written to your contacts.
See, edit, create, and delete all of your Google Drive files	Saving the year-end PDF archive to Drive, and opening your old sheet during a migration.	Rollover creates a PDF; migration opens the old spreadsheet you point it at.
Connect to an external service	A read-only check of the shared "Version Tracker" sheet so you're told when a newer template ships.	The only outside call the tool makes. It reads release dates/links — never your data.
Run when you're not present / manage its own triggers	The automatic triggers: instant Contact Log updates, the nightly rebuild/sync (around 10 PM), and the update check on open.	Lets the sheet keep itself current without you clicking Build every time.
Display and run third-party web content in dialogs and sidebars	The menus, wizards, and sidebars — Settings, Migration, Rollover, and the progress bars.	These custom screens are how you drive the tool.

> **Bottom line on permissions**
>
> Every scope above operates only within your own Google account. There is no server or database belonging to the developer — see Part 4.

Step 4 — Load your data (the RAW Data tab)

Before logging calls, the system needs to know who your students are. Export data from your standard systems and paste it into the brightly-colored "PASTE" boxes on the **RAW Data** tab.

> **🚨 CRITICAL — always paste as values only**
>
> When pasting into RAW Data, use Edit → Paste Special → Values Only (Ctrl+Shift+V). Pasting normally can drag in formatting or formulas that break the build.

Insight / ATS data — Blue section → paste into cell A5 (required)

1. Go to TeachHub and sign in.

2. In the search bar, look up and open Insight.
3. Go to Tools → Downloader.
4. Under "Data Available for Download," select only **Guardian Contact Information**, then download.
5. Copy the data and paste it into **cell A5** (Paste Special → Values Only).

ParentSquare data — Orange section → paste into cell AG6 (optional)

1. Go to ParentSquare, sign in, and open Admin.
2. Under Data Assistant, select Parents.
3. Click Export CSV.
4. Copy the data and paste it into **cell AG6**.

NYCSA data — Green section → paste into cell AP2 (optional)

1. Go to TeachHub and sign in.
2. Open Family Access Management.
3. Export the "Students with Non-NYCSA Account" report.
4. Copy the data and paste it into **cell AP2**.

Easier way: 📥 Input Data Mode

Open 🚀 **App Menu** → 📥 **Input Data Mode** and the sheet walks you through the three exports one at a time, then two optional steps: **Site / Class** (each class's teacher and site) and **Your Lists** (below). Your other tabs are hidden while you work. For each export, either click 📂 **Upload file** and pick the file you downloaded, or open the file, press Ctrl+A (Mac: ⌘+A), copy (Ctrl+C / ⌘+C), and paste anywhere on the temporary tab with Ctrl+Shift+V (Mac: ⌘+Shift+V). The data moves into RAW Data by itself, and the sidebar shows when each one was last updated. It warns you, without changing RAW Data, if you pasted the wrong export or if Excel cut numbers off (like 7.19E+09). Use **Skip** to keep the old data for an export, or **Exit** to stop and get your tabs back. When you're done, click 🏗️ **Build Sheets Now**.

Your own lists (Input Data Mode, Your Lists step)

Have a list that isn't an ATS export, like bus routes, after-school sign-ups, PTA members or trip forms? On the **Your Lists** step, click ➕ **Add another list**, name it, and paste the whole sheet (headers too) into the yellow box on the new 📥 **(name)** tab. The sidebar then takes you through three short steps:

1. **Columns.** It finds the header row by itself (title rows above it are fine) and guesses what each column is, shown like *OSIS: Column C "OSIS"*. Fix a guess with its dropdown, and say whether each row is a **student** or a **guardian**. A name can be one column ("LAST, FIRST" is fine) or two (first + last).
2. **Variables.** The other columns (a route, a fee, a form status). Tick **keep**, give it a name, and choose what a blank cell shows and what everyone who isn't on the list gets: nothing, or your own text (like "No bus"). Then choose where it shows: under **Additional Information** on the phone contact (above Communications), and/or as a column in the **Student List** (student lists) or **Parents Divided** (guardian lists).

3. **Match.** It works out who each row is: OSIS first, then names, then phone or email, then best guesses for short names and nicknames (Sam → Samuel). Rows it isn't sure of are listed for you: confirm a best guess, pick one of several possible students, search the whole Student List, or skip the row. ✔ **Accept all best guesses** takes them all at once; check a couple first, because best guesses can be wrong.

Your picks are remembered: when you get a new version of the list, click **Paste new version** and only the new rows need you. The list's tab shows who each row matched (✔ Matched / How). What you keep reaches the Student List, Parents Divided and the phone contacts at the next build; Combined Contact Tracking doesn't change. Add as many lists as you like.

> ⚠️ **Anything shown under Additional Information goes into your Google Contacts**
>
> It is on the guardian's contact (and your phone) after the next sync. Keep private lists (IEP, housing, health) off, or keep them on their own tab only.

Missing or wrong data? Use the New/Edit Student override

District databases like ATS can lag behind real enrollment. If you need to add a student or fix contact info before it hits ATS, use 👤 **Student Overrides** → **New / Edit Student**. When you build, your overrides are applied to the Student List, Combined Contact Tracking, Parents Divided, Phone Contacts, and the Ghost Typist. The **Directory** tab and the build report's new / discharged students always show ATS (RAW Data) only. Overrides also tidy themselves up: a "New Student" override is removed once ATS has that student, an edit that ATS now matches exactly is removed too, and a student's class always follows RAW Data once they're in ATS. (More in Part 2.)

Customizing dropdowns — the Type List

The optional **Type** column in the Contact Log is driven by the Type List in the hidden **Backend** tab (column BL). Unhide Backend and edit that column to set your own conversation-topic categories (for example: Attendance, Behavior, Enrollment, IEP).

Step 5 — Build the sheets

Run 🚀 **App Menu** → 🏗️ **Build Sheets Only**. A progress sidebar generates every derived tab, checking off each step as it goes (reading your data, Student List, Event Log, Combined Contact Tracking, Parents Divided, Directory, Phone Contacts, finishing up) with a line under each saying what it builds. When it finishes, the sidebar shows a short report — new students, discharged students, and families newly signed up for NYCSA or ParentSquare (click a count to see the names). The *first* successful build unlocks the full menu — a toast asks you to press **F5** to refresh.

> **The golden rule of this sheet**
>
> RAW Data is the only tab you paste into. Everything else is generated — so re-running Build always safely rebuilds it. Never hand-type into Student List, Directory, or other generated tabs.

Part 2 — Buttons & Features

After setup, three custom menus sit at the top of the screen, to the right of "Help": 🚀 **App Menu**, 👤 **Student Overrides**, and 📆 **Events**.

🚀 App Menu

Menu item	What it does
🧱 Full Sync (Build + Push to Google Contacts)	Rebuilds every sheet AND pushes the directory to your Google Contacts. Only appears when phone syncing is on. Opens a progress sidebar you can pause or stop.
🏗️ Build Sheets Only (No Push)	Your everyday "refresh everything" button. Regenerates all derived tabs from RAW Data + Contact Log + overrides, without touching your phone contacts.
⚙️ Settings	Show/hide tabs and columns, control live updates, filter notes, manage discharged students (full list below).
📖 Open User Guide	Opens this guide.
🐞 Report a Bug	Opens a short Google Form to report anything broken or confusing.
📥 Input Data Mode	Walks you through loading each export, then Site / Class and Your Lists, one step at a time (Part 1, Step 4).
🔔 Check for Updates	Manually checks whether a newer template has been released, and lets you set update preferences.
🔄 End of Year Rollover	Archives the year to a PDF, freezes the sheet, and hands you next year's fresh template (Part 3).

👤 Student Overrides

"Overrides" let you correct or add student and guardian info without editing the raw ATS data.

Menu item	What it does
✨ New / Edit Student	Add a student who isn't in ATS, or correct a name, phone, email, language, grade, or up to 5 guardians (a student's class always follows RAW Data once they're in ATS). Also set a status Label and "Hide from Report (Stealth Mode)." Saving opens the Build sidebar and rebuilds the sheets (if rebuilds are paused in Settings, it just saves).
🗂️ Manage Overrides	See every override you've made; edit or delete any of them.
📄 Override Report	A side-by-side "Students Override Report" comparing raw ATS data against your overrides. Stealth-mode students are skipped.

📆 Events

Use the Events tab for large-scale attendances (workshops, graduations, fairs) so they don't clutter your daily Contact Log. Click 📆 **Events** → 📋 **New Event**. A pop-up with a calendar picker asks for the event name, type/category (with a **PTC Quick Fill** button for "Parent Teacher Conference"), and location, then builds an attendance table. Log attendees by OSIS, student name, or guardian name — type one, paste a whole column, or put several OSIS numbers in one cell separated by commas — and the Ghost Typist fills in the rest. Attendees map back to each student's Combined Contact Tracking and tally automatically in PCAR.

The tabs — what each one is for

Tab	Purpose	Visible by default?
RAW Data	Your export paste zone — the only tab you paste raw data into (ATS / ParentSquare / NYCSA).	Hidden (show in Settings)
Contact Log	The heart of the tool. Log every guardian contact here (deep dive below).	Yes
Student List	The generated roster (called “Master Table” in older copies): OSIS, student, guardian, site, class, siblings, status, the date of the last interaction, and a column for each student list you keep (Your Lists). Data starts on row 5.	Hidden (generated)
Directory	A clean, printable class directory built from your RAW Data (ATS): each student's site, class/teacher, and parents' email and phone. Overrides and discharged students aren't included.	Yes (generated)
Combined Contact Tracking	One comprehensive history block per student — all notes and event attendances together. Great before an IEP meeting. Only students on the Student List get a block, so notes logged under a mistyped or unknown OSIS don't show here.	Yes (generated)
PCAR	Your auto-compiled PCAR numbers (Phone, Walk-In, Workshops, PTCs, totals).	Yes (generated)
Phone Contacts	The exact data pushed to Google Contacts, including the Additional Information lines from Your Lists.	Hidden (optional)
Parents Divided	One row per guardian (with ParentSquare / NYCSA flags, and a column for each guardian list you keep). Handy for mail merges.	Hidden (optional)
Notes	An optional manual notes tab (one row per family) with its own auto-fill and duplicate protection. Its notes show at the top of that student's Combined Contact Tracking.	Hidden (optional)
Send Out	Optional tab tied to extra PCAR rows.	Hidden (optional)

Tab	Purpose	Visible by default?
📥 Your lists	One tab per list you add in Input Data Mode (Your Lists step): your pasted list, plus ✔ Matched / How columns showing who each row is.	Yes (yours)
Backend	Behind-the-scenes sections side by side: Version & saved settings (A:E), New/Edit Student overrides (G:AV), event log (AX:BF), Send Out list (BH:BJ), the Type List that drives the Contact Log Type dropdown (BL), Additional Information (BN:BQ, rewritten by every build) and the Your Lists setups (BS:BV). Only edit the Type List.	Hidden (system)

The Contact Log, in depth

This is your primary workspace for phone calls, emails, and 1-on-1 meetings. It's designed so you type as little as possible.

The Pre-Call Search Bar

At the top of the Contact Log is a search bar. Before you call a family, type a student's name or OSIS to instantly pull up your most recent interaction with them — so you walk into the call with context.

Logging a new interaction (left → right)

Column	What to put there
Date	The date of the interaction. Auto-fills to today if blank; type your own to back-date.
Find Student	Type ONE of three things — the parent's name, the OSIS, or the student's name. The Ghost Typist fills in the rest of the profile.
Person Spoke With	The specific parent/guardian you actually spoke to.
#	Number of interactions, for PCAR counting. A normal call = 1; a mass email to 30 parents = 30. Auto-fills to 1 if blank.
Site & Class	(Optional) Auto-fills from the student's profile; can be hidden in Settings.
📱🚶 Category	Categorize for PCAR — e.g., Phone, Walk-In, Parent-Teacher.
Method	The exact method — Call, Email, In School, etc.
Type	(Optional) A custom topic dropdown driven by the Backend tab's Type List; can be hidden in Settings.
Event Description	Detailed notes about the conversation.
⁉️ Follow-Up Needed	A visual flag: Yes · Yes – Important · No · Waiting on Someone · Completed. Auto-fills to "No" if blank.

Column	What to put there
Additional Notes	Next steps or what you did after the initial contact (e.g., "Teacher will reach out").
Hide	Check this box to keep this note out of the compiled notes (Combined Contact Tracking and Phone Contacts). The row stays in the Contact Log and still counts for PCAR.

Three things the Contact Log does for you automatically:

- **Ghost Typist.** Type — or paste a whole column of — OSIS numbers, student names, or guardian names, and the other identity columns (plus Site and Class, including for siblings) fill in for every row. If it can't match, it warns "Could not find … in the Student List" (after a paste, it lists the ones it couldn't find).
- **Smart auto-fill.** Entering real content stamps today's Date, sets # to 1, and Follow-up to "No" — but only where you left them blank. Anything you typed yourself is never overwritten.
- **Auto-adding rows + the master hide filter.** A fresh blank row is always kept above the dark "END" bar. The checkbox on the END-bar row turns on a filter that shows only this and last week's rows (or only today's — see Settings), plus anything still marked for follow-up.

> **If the Ghost Typist says "Could not find … in the Student List"**
> That family isn't compiled yet. Run 🏗️ Build Sheets Only once, then try again.

⚙️ Settings — every toggle explained

Setting	What it controls
Sync Contacts to Phones (Nightly)	Master switch for phone sync. When on, the nightly run pushes the directory into Google Contacts (and the Full Sync menu item appears).
Show these tabs	Show or hide any tab (every tab except Backend). Contact Log, Combined Contact Tracking, PCAR and Directory start shown; the rest start hidden.
Show Site & Class (Contact Log)	Shows/hides the Site and Class columns in the Contact Log.
Show "Type" (Contact Log)	Shows/hides the Type column in the Contact Log.
Rebuilds: Manual / Nightly Sync Only	"Fast entry mode." Skips the live rebuild after every edit; sheets refresh on Build or the nightly sync. Great for bulk entry.
Disable Nightly Sync Entirely	Turns off the automatic nightly rebuild and phone sync completely.
Update Contact Log only on Build	Notes stop syncing on every edit and update only when you run Build.

Setting	What it controls
Disable Contact Log Auto-Fill	Stops auto-stamping Date, #, and Follow-up. The parent/student/OSIS lookup still fills in.
Contact Log: Show Today Only	Off shows this and last week's rows in the Contact Log; on shows only today's. Important notes and open follow-ups always show.
Date Range for Compiled Notes	Limits compiled notes to a window (Last Month / 6 Months / Year presets). Blank = all time.
Disable Hidden Notes (Show All)	Includes notes you've hidden with the row checkbox in the compiled output.
Hide "Discharged" in Student List	Visual only — filters discharged students out of view.
Purge Discharged Students	Permanently deletes discharged students from the Student List. Cannot be undone.
Reset to Default Settings	Returns every toggle to its default (optional tabs/columns hidden, features on).

> **Settings travel with your copy.**
> Your choices are saved into the hidden Backend tab, so a future upgrade copy inherits them automatically.

Build vs. Full Sync — know the difference

Command	What it is
🏗️ Build / Rebuild Data	An internal action. Takes your RAW Data and constructs all the automated sheets (Directory, Student List, Parents Divided, Phone Contacts, PCAR). It only organizes data inside the spreadsheet.
🧱 Full Sync with Google Contacts	An external action. Pushes the formatted Phone Contacts tab into your actual Google Contacts via a "School Directory" label — one number per card — so a parent's name, relationship, and student show on caller ID.

The phone sync runs in "mirror" mode — creating, editing, and removing contacts so the label always matches your directory. It runs nightly or on demand via 🧱 **Full Sync**, with a progress sidebar you can pause, stop, or restart; it's resilient and resumes if it hits Google's time limits.

Part 3 — Migration & Updates

Importing data from an older sheet (Migration Wizard)

Open 🚀 **App Menu** → 🔄 **Import Old Data**. (On an "upgrade" copy it opens by itself.) Paste the link to your older PC sheet and click **Start Safe Migration**. The wizard runs six steps:

1. Connect to the old sheet (confirms the link works and you have access).
2. Recover your custom settings (inferred from which tabs were visible in the old sheet).
3. Migrate your ATS Raw Data.
4. Transfer your Events, Send Out, and Student Overrides.
5. Smart-map the Contact Log — it matches columns by their headers, so it still works even if the layout changed, and strips blank/"ghost" rows.
6. Finalize and rebuild all directories.

> **Migration is one-directional and non-destructive.**
> It reads your old sheet and writes into the new one. Nothing is deleted from the old sheet — keep it as a backup.

Staying current (the update checker)

Each copy remembers its own build date. Quietly, on open (at most once every few hours), the sheet checks a shared **Version Tracker** to see whether a newer template has shipped. If so, it pops a short changelog with a link to the newest copy. You can also check any time with 🚀 **App Menu** → 🔔 **Check for Updates**.

Inside that dialog you can:

- **Dismiss for now** — close it; it pops up again on the next check.
- **Dismiss this update** — hide this update until something even newer ships.
- **Major updates only** — automatic pop-ups only for big releases (a manual check still shows everything).
- **Stop automatic update checks** — silence the on-open checks; the manual menu check always still works.

How to actually adopt an update

Updates don't rewrite your current sheet in place. To move up a version: open the new template link, **make a copy**, run Initial Setup, then use the **Migration Wizard** to bring your data across. Your settings come along automatically.

End of Year Rollover

When the year ends, run 🚀 **App Menu** → 🔄 **End of Year Rollover**. It:

- Generates a permanent PDF archive of your Contact Log and Combined Contact Tracking, saved next to your sheet in Drive.
- Freezes the sheet — turns off nightly and phone sync so it won't overwrite next year's data — and renames it "… – Retired on [date]."
- Hands you the link to next year's fresh, fast template.

> **Rollover is safe to run once you're done for the year.**
>
> It archives and freezes the OLD sheet; you then set up a brand-new copy for the new year. Keep the retired sheet and its PDF as your record.

Part 4 — Security & Privacy

> **The short version: I cannot see your sheet, your students, your contacts, or your Drive.**
> This tool has no server and no database of mine. The code runs entirely inside your own Google account. Nothing about your families is ever sent to me or anyone else. Once you make a copy, it's yours.

Why that's true

- **It runs as you, on Google's servers.** When you click Authorize, you grant permission to the script — running inside your account — not to me. I receive nothing.
- **There's no outside destination for your data.** The tool reads and writes your own spreadsheet and (optionally) your own Google Contacts. It doesn't phone home.
- **You can read every line of the code.** Open Extensions → Apps Script in the sheet.
- **You can revoke access anytime.** Go to myaccount.google.com → Security → Your connections to third-party apps & services, and remove the tool.

Why the "unverified app" warning appears

That screen shows for personal Apps Script tools that aren't published to Google's Marketplace. It means Google hasn't run a formal brand review — *not* that the tool is unsafe. For a permission-by-permission breakdown, see **"What each authorization actually does"** in Part 1.

The only things that ever leave your sheet

- **The update check** reads a shared, view-only "Version Tracker" spreadsheet to compare dates. It sends nothing about your students.
- **Migration** opens an older sheet only when you paste its link, and only because you already have access to it.
- **Bug reports** go through a Google Form you choose to fill out — only the words you type are shared.

> **Who can see your copy?**
> Entirely up to you. Once you make a copy it lives in your Drive; you decide who (if anyone) gets shared access.

Tips, Workflow & Troubleshooting

A good daily workflow

1. Before a call, use the Contact Log search bar to pull up the family's history.
2. Made a contact? In a new row, type the OSIS or a name and let the Ghost Typist fill the rest. Add notes and a follow-up flag.
3. Need to fix a name/phone or add a missing student? Use 👤 Student Overrides → New / Edit Student.
4. Fresh ATS export? Paste it into RAW Data (Paste Special → Values Only), then run 🏗️ Build Sheets Only.
5. Big batch? Turn on "Rebuilds: Manual / Nightly Sync Only," then run Build once at the end.

Handy tips

- **Siblings are automatic.** The tool joins siblings by OSIS and fills Site/Class for each.
- **Back-dating works.** Type your own date, count, or follow-up status and the auto-fill leaves it alone.
- **Hide vs. Purge discharged.** "Hide Discharged" is a reversible view filter; "Purge" permanently deletes.
- **Refresh if a menu looks stale.** Pressing F5 always reloads the latest menu.
- **Fresh-data reminder.** If your ATS, ParentSquare or NYCSA data in RAW Data is older than your reminder setting (a week by default), the sheet shows a reminder once a day when you open it. Change it or turn it off in ⚙️ Settings → Student data.
- **Lists match best with OSIS.** If a list you add has an OSIS column, every row with an OSIS matches exactly; names alone need more checking.

Troubleshooting / FAQ

Symptom	Fix
The custom menus didn't appear	Wait a few seconds, then press F5. If it's a brand-new copy, run 🚨 Initial Setup first.
"🔒 Action Blocked" when I type	Setup hasn't been run yet. Click 🚀 App Menu → 🚨 Initial Setup (Run Once).
Pasted data looks broken / directory is wrong	Re-paste using Edit → Paste Special → Values Only, then run 🏗️ Build Sheets Only.
Ghost Typist: "Could not find … in the Student List"	That family isn't compiled yet. Run 🏗️ Build Sheets Only, then try again.

Symptom	Fix
"📡 Background Sync in Progress" warning	A rebuild/sync is running. Wait for it to finish before entering new data.
Update checker says I'm up to date but there's a new version	Use 🔔 Check for Updates (it bypasses the throttle). If still wrong, report a bug.
Phone sync created duplicates / didn't finish	Open Full Sync, use Stop then Restart. The sync mirrors the sheet and cleans up on the next full run.
A row on my list says “not found”	That student (or guardian) isn't on the Student List. A new student? Add them with 👤 New / Edit Student, build, then open the list again (📥 Input Data Mode → Your Lists → Edit setup). Or pick them by hand with 🔍 Pick from the Student List.
Something's broken or confusing	Use 🚀 App Menu → 🐞 Report a Bug, or email jacob.keller@p94m.org.

Do & Don't

✅ Do	🚫 Don't
Paste raw data only into RAW Data — as Values Only.	Type into Student List, Directory, or other generated tabs — they're overwritten on build.
Use Overrides to fix names, phones, or add students.	Rename or delete the generated / hidden tabs (including Backend).
Run Build after big changes.	Hand-edit the hidden Backend tab's saved settings.
Keep your old / retired sheet as a backup until the new one is verified.	Purge discharged students unless you're certain.

Glossary

Term	Meaning
OSIS	The unique student ID number from ATS. Used to match students, siblings, and contacts.
ATS / Insight	The NYC DOE student data systems your Raw Data export comes from (via TeachHub).
PCAR	Parent Coordinator Activity Report — the reporting numbers this tool compiles.
Ghost Typist	The auto-fill that completes a Contact Log, Notes, or Events row from a single OSIS or name.
Override	A correction or addition to student/guardian info without changing raw ATS data.
Stealth Mode	An override flag that keeps a student out of the Override Report.

Term	Meaning
NYCSA / ParentSquare	Parent account/communication systems whose exports show each family's sign-up status in Parents Divided and Phone Contacts.
Build	Regenerating all derived tabs from your current data (🏗️ Build Sheets Only).
Your Lists	Your own lists (bus routes, PTA…) added in Input Data Mode's last step. Each row is matched to a student or guardian; what you keep shows under Additional Information and as Student List / Parents Divided columns.
Additional Information	The lines from Your Lists on a phone contact, above Communications. Kept in the Backend tab and rewritten by every build.

Getting this into Google Drive

You can keep and share this guide as a Google Doc in a couple of ways:

Option A — Upload and convert (recommended)

1. Go to drive.google.com and open the folder where you want it.
2. Drag the **PC_Tracker_User_Guide.docx** file into the window (or click New → File upload).
3. Right-click the uploaded file → Open with → Google Docs. Drive converts it to a Google Doc; the Jump-to buttons and table of contents stay clickable.
4. (Optional) Delete the original .docx once the Google Doc is created.

Option B — From inside Google Docs

1. Open docs.google.com and start a blank document.
2. Choose File → Open → Upload, and drop in the .docx.

This PDF

The PDF you're reading has a "Jump to" button bar and a clickable table of contents that jump to each section — handy for reading on a phone or sharing a read-only copy.
